

Enjoying variety

Exercise is more than just going to the gym, although it can take time for a teen to figure out what physical activity they like best. When it's enjoyable, exercise often doesn't feel like exercise at all.

Trying new things can be a great way to stay interested in exercise. Going to an observation session with a friend can provide much-needed support if a teen's nervous about trying out something new. As with everything, practice makes perfect, so if teens feel they aren't making progress at first, they shouldn't give up.

▽ Keep it varied

Trying out lots of activities and learning new skills will help teens find out what they most enjoy.



△ Running builds muscle, increases cardiovascular strength, and improves endurance.



△ Cycling is a healthy way to get around, builds muscle, and improves cardiovascular strength.



△ Climbing strengthens bones and muscles and challenges problem-solving skills.



△ Team sports boost confidence and provide a regular exercise routine.



△ Boxing builds coordination, discipline, and strength.



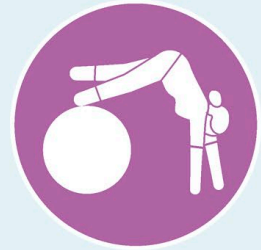
△ Dancing improves coordination, rhythm, and stamina.



△ Yoga increases flexibility and muscle strength, and helps to relieve stress.



△ Group activities are a great way to make friends through teamwork.



△ Pilates strengthens core muscles and improves flexibility.

TEEN HINTS

Getting motivated

People have more energy, and tend to enjoy it more, if they exercise often. Finding time to exercise regularly, such as after school, and a friend to exercise with, makes sticking to it easier and more fun. The main goal shouldn't be about competing, but rather aiming to enjoy how it makes you feel. Setting goals may also motivate you—for example, meeting new people, getting healthier, or feeling less stressed.